

Effective Communication

Week 11

ECOMM AY2026

April Semester

Subject Schedule

11	29 Jun – 3 Jul 2026	Speaking Effectively (Face-to-face) • Spoken vs written language • Verbal communication strategies • Structure of a speech	• Scripting a speech	Article Submission (30%) – 30 Jun 2026, 11:59pm
12	6 – 10 Jul 2026	Speaking Effectively (Face-to-face) • Non-verbal communication strategies	• AI Presenter Coach	
13	13 – 17 Jul 2026	Speaking Effectively (Online via MS Teams) • Visual aids for presentation • Use of digital space	• Presentation slides	
14	20 – 24 Jul 2026	Flex Week		
15	27 – 31 Jul 2026	Speaking Effectively (Face-to-face) • Group presentation techniques	• Handling questions	
16	3 – 7 Aug 2026	Seminar Presentation (Face-to-face)	• Practice / Feedback	Seminar Presentation (35%) *9 – 10 Aug 2026 National Day PH
17	10 – 14 Aug 2026	Seminar Presentation (Face-to-face)	• Practice / Feedback	
18	17 – 21 Aug 2026	Study Week		

What did we cover in
Week 7?

Recap

Recap



5Cs in Writing (Clear,
Concise, Concrete,
Complete, Cohesive)



Writing the Article
(Introduction, Discussion,
Conclusion)



Using Digital Tools to
Check Grammar and
Plagiarism

Weeks 11 - 17

Seminar Presentation Skills

**Darius Poon
ENG/AMS, 2014.**



You Have Been Invited to Speak at the TP Talks Seminar

- **Date:** Weeks 16 & 17
- **Time:** Tutorial Time
- **Venue:** Classroom
- **Duration of presentation:** 3 - 4 min per speaker.

Note: Content presented beyond the allocated 4 minutes will not be assessed.



Learning Outcomes

In this week's lesson, you will:

- understand differences between the language of a written document, and the language of a speech.
- apply the rhetorical features of spoken language in your speech.
- organise your speech according to a three-part structure.

What is a seminar?

A seminar is an event, class, meeting or conference for:

- discussion
- training
- education
- business



What is the difference?

An article vs A speech?



Merwyn Sim
HSS/PSY, 2023

Title: Creating a Visual Arts and Writing Club in Temasek Polytechnic

INTRODUCTION

In June 2022, Deputy Prime Minister Lawrence Wong posted this message on social media, "[Set your path, think about what you want to achieve and go for it with all your heart](#)". This reminded me of my dream of creating a new CCA. In my first year at Temasek Polytechnic (TP), I visited the CCA Fair and realised that out of the [77 CCAs in TP](#), none of them could fulfil my interest in visual arts and writing. This led me to create a CCA dedicated to the visual arts and writing. I'm proud to share that in 2022, my friends and I founded the Visual Arts and Writing Club (VAWC), a club that cultivates life skills, supports the community, and moulds leaders.

DISCUSSION

Cultivating life skills

A new CCA that encourages creativity through visual arts and writing will help students cultivate important life skills. One of the benefits of an arts education, as reported by [UNESCO](#), is the opportunity for students to innovate and problem-solve. These life skills teach students to embrace failure as part of the creative process, which is essential to developing a growth mindset. [MOE](#) Art teachers are also encouraged to help nurture students' growth mindset through arts.



Life skills including innovative thinking.

Photo Credit: [UNESCO](#)

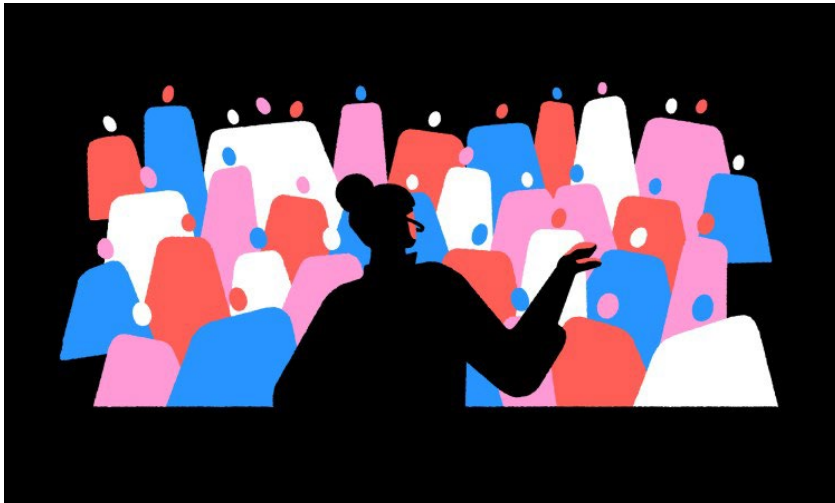
In secondary school, I volunteered for an art project where I faced a challenge trying to display a poem on a painting. I solved this problem by carving the poem on a plastic sheet to create a stencil and projecting light through it. I saw the value

Spoken & Written Language

What are the key differences?

Seminar Presentation (Speech)

- It involves **speaking & listening** - an important difference.
- The audience **listens**. **What's the implication?**



Article (Written)

- It involves **writing & reading**.
- The audience **reads (silently)**.

Title: Creating a Visual Arts and Writing Club in Temasek Polytechnic

INTRODUCTION

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Read aloud

Activity 1:

Pair work

Compare two different texts

1. Read excerpt 1 and excerpt 2 in the following slides **aloud** to each other.
2. Note the difference & discuss
 - Which was easier to read aloud?
 - Which was easier to listen to?
 - Why?
3. Share: Which is better for a speech?

Topic: Kindness during the pandemic

Which excerpt
is better for a
speech?
Why?



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Excerpt 1

"One approach for enhancing patience and tolerance is engaging in situationalism. This is the practice of considering external circumstances that could explain someone's seemingly irresponsible behaviour rather than reducing the act to a judgement about the individual's personality or character (e.g.: They're just stupid, lazy, ignorant, greedy, etc.)"

By Bobby Cheon, [Angst and anger: Why does the Covid 19 pandemic make us so upset?](#) May 18, 2020, *Agency for Science, Technology & Research*.

Topic: Kindness during the pandemic

Which excerpt
is better for a
speech?
Why?



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Excerpt 2

"Kindness is something that I experienced during the pandemic. Now, I want to give back to society. I want to show the same kindness to others as I had been shown. I realise that not everybody knows my story, and I don't know theirs. So, I have decided to be kind to everyone."

Anshika Singh, "Lost in Translation," Aug. 12, 2021. [ASPAC: Youth Got This! ASPAC](#)

Spoken & Written Language

Key Differences

Seminar (Speech)

Written to be heard

Language

- More conversational
- Words with fewer syllables, like "so" instead of "therefore"
- Shorter sentences (**written to be heard, not to be read**).

Article (Written)

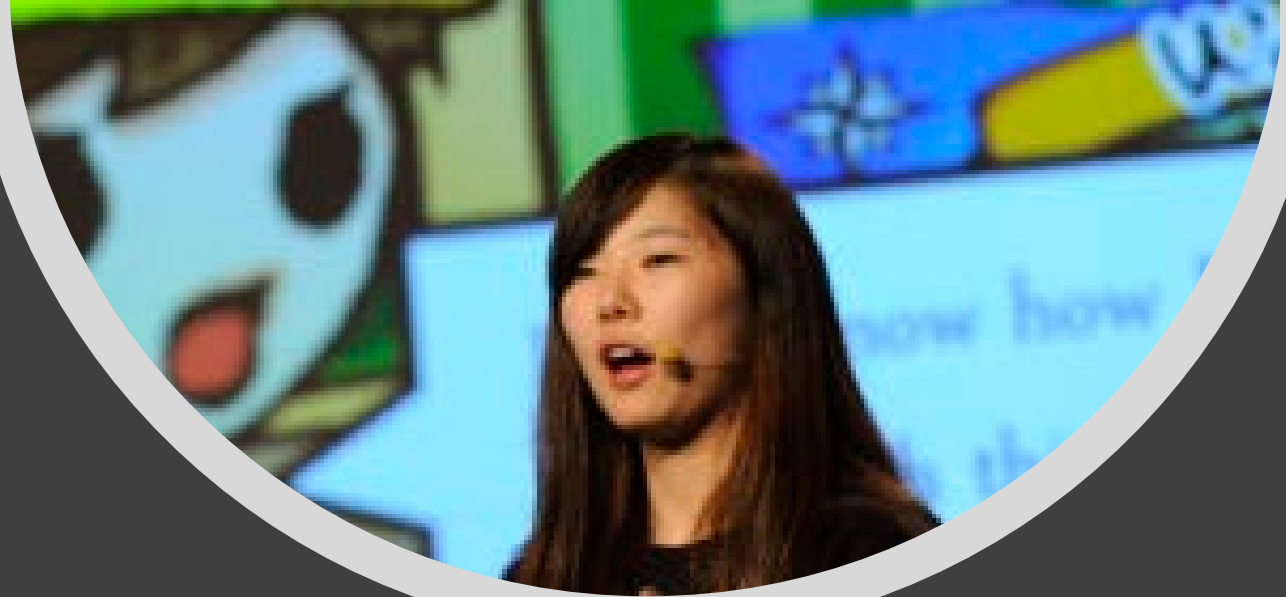
Written to be read

Language

- Less conversational
- Longer words with more syllables, e.g.: "situationalism"
- Longer sentences (**written to be read, not to be heard**).

Verbal Communication Strategies for a speech:

Rhetorical devices:
Words, phrases, sentence patterns





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Verbal communication: Rhetorical devices

Rhetoric is **the art** of effective communication.

Rhetorical devices are **words, phrases or sentence patterns** deliberately chosen to:

- convey meaning
- provoke a reaction, and
- persuade your listener

In this section, we will cover these three devices:

- The rule of three
- Contrast
- Rhetorical questions

Activity 2

View, listen & share

**BTS – United Nations
(2017)
‘Love myself’
#EndViolenceCampaign**

To combat
violence among children

Listen & view this excerpt from the speech
by Kim Namjoon of BTS to the United Nations General
Assembly in 2018. **BTS at the U.N. 2018** (40 seconds)

Share in pairs or groups:

- What did you remember?
- Why?



<https://www.youtube.com/clip/UgkxhK5om0ZTwj2VO93cvi8sdt9p1a7cmVyA>

What rhetorical device did the speaker use?

"...**yesterday's** me is still me.
Today, I am who I am, with all my faults and mistakes.
Tomorrow, I may be a tiny bit wiser, and that would be me too."

I have come to love myself for
who I was,
who I am, and
who I hope to become.



Kim Namjoon of BTS

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The rule of three – Purpose?

- **Structure of a speech**

Introduction

Body

Conclusion

- **Content**

"I would like to present a solution that can be described in three words:

Simple. Innovative. Green."



~ Arief Irfan, TP/Engineering, 2014

Can you describe your main message in 3 words?

The rule of three is the oldest presentation technique since Aristotle's time.

The rule of three

Why three?

Ideas in threes are more:

- interesting
- persuasive
- memorable

Why?

- Repetition & rhythm
- Feels complete (not too many & not too few)
- Feels natural? We are used to listing things in sets of three.: “Reduce, reuse, recycle”; “First, second, third”; “Ready, steady, go!”



Contrast – Purpose?

"There are a lot of experts today, **but** there is **no** expert for the **future**."

- [Jack Ma](#), Hong Kong University Congregation, 2018

"The Earth's resources are **limited**, **but** human ingenuity is **infinite**." - [Ryan Bourne, Cato Institute](#)

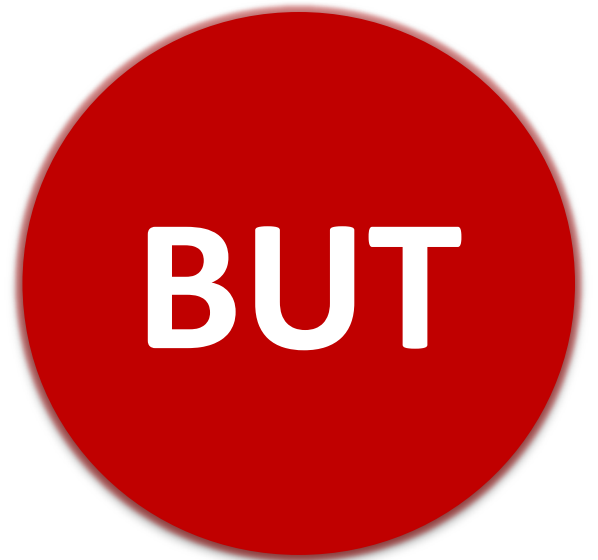


Photo by [Mitchell Luo](#) on [Unsplash](#)

Contrast – Purpose?

What is the purpose of using contrast?

- Surprises your audience
- Changes expectations
- Sustains attention -> helps the audience remember your message



In which part of your speech would the use of contrast be effective?



Rhetorical questions – Purpose?

Why is it that countries that are **so powerful** in creating **wars**, are **so weak** in bringing **peace**?

Why is it that giving **guns** is **so easy**, but giving **books** is **so hard**?

Why is it that **building tanks** is **so easy**, but **building schools** is **so hard**?

Malala Yousafzai 2014, Nobel Peace Prize Laureate

Can you identify another rhetorical device used in this speech besides rhetorical questions?

Rhetorical questions – Purpose?



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Why ask a rhetorical question in a speech?

1. Stirs emotion

E.g.: "Why is it that countries that are so powerful in creating wars, are so weak in bringing peace?" [Malala Yousafzai, 2022](#)

2. Engages the audience to think

3. Invites the audience to agree with you

4. Highlights divergent views

E.g.: "How can we stop online bullying? Is educating bullies the answer? What about stricter penalties for bullies?"



Rhetorical Devices

Rule of Three

Use of Contrast

Rhetorical Questions

Which rhetorical devices should I use?

Think of these factors:

1. Message
2. Purpose
3. Audience

What words, phrases or sentence patterns will help me to:

- convey my message clearly & convincingly.
- make the audience think, feel and want to do something.
- leave a memorable impression on the listener.

Scripting: Rewrite your article as a speech. What changes do you have to make to the phrasing to get your message across effectively in my speech?





Activity 3: Try Scripting

1. Select a section (three to five sentences) from your Article for this activity.
2. Rewrite it **for the listener (for the ear)**.
3. Shorten the long sentences.
4. Consider using one or more of these devices:
 - The rule of three
 - “But” to highlight contrast
 - Rhetorical Questions (Those that arouse interest or are thought provoking)
 - Other devices you have used successfully in previous speeches

*Homework: Continue scripting your speech. Remember to write for the ear, not the eye.



Structure of your Seminar Speech

Seminar Speech Vs Article Structure

Structure of the Seminar Speech

Introduction

- **Attention getter**
- Main message

Discussion

- Three main points

Conclusion

- Reiterate the main message and the three reasons
- **Action ending**

Structure of the Article

Introduction

- Context / background
- Main message
- Purpose

Discussion

- Three main points

Conclusion

- Reiterate the main message and the three reasons
- Call to action: Invite readers to the seminar

Template for scripting your speech

Download from LMS

Refer to the Sample in LMS

Presentation Script

Name:	Adm. No:	Tutorial group:
Title:		
Introduction		
Attention Getter	Get attention and build rapport with the audience Examples: • Relate a personal experience. • Tell a story or anecdote. • Reveal something about yourself. • Ask a thought-provoking question. • Show an image, photograph or an object. • Reveal something not commonly known. • Use a quotation etc.	
Main Message	What is the main message? E.g.: "Although procrastination is generally viewed negatively, it does have some potential benefits."	
Body		
First Main Point	Signal the start of the first main point Signpost Language: E.g.: • Firstly,... • To begin.. • I will begin with... • Any statement that signals the first main point	

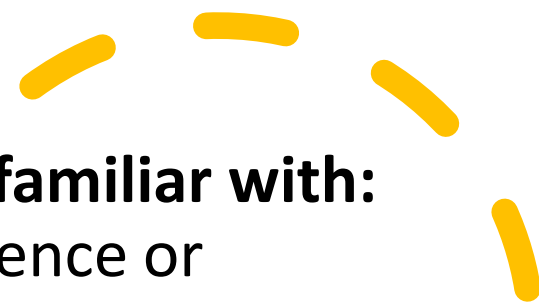
Introduction

- Attention getter
- Main message

Introduction	
Attention Getter	Get attention and build rapport with the audience Examples: • Relate a personal experience. • Tell a story or anecdote. • Reveal something about yourself. • Ask a thought-provoking question. • Show an image, photograph or an object. • Reveal something not commonly known. • Use a quotation etc.
Main Message	What is the main message? E.g.: "Although procrastination is generally viewed negatively, it does have some potential benefits."



Make a List of Attention Getters



Here are some you may be familiar with:

- Relating a personal experience or personal information
- Telling a story or an anecdote
- Asking a thought-provoking question
- Starting with a quote
- Using an analogy (e.g.: Comparing time with money.)
- Showing a photograph, an image or an object
- A combination: e.g.: A photograph & story
- Others?

Attention-getter A personal experience

Alliya Insyirah

Topic: Scams

School of ENG
Diploma in BZE

October 2021/22 Sem

Attention Getter

Topic: Internet Scams



Alliya Insyirah Binte Kamalrudin
School of ENG/Diploma in BZE
October 2021/22

<https://youtu.be/uTrBkdkbOfI>

Personal stories or revelations as attention getters



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People like stories. What's your story?

Based on your:

- experiences
- childhood or other memories
- observations
- insights
- thoughts & feelings
- Or stories about family and / or friends



More examples of attention getters to listen on your own.

- A thought-provoking question
- A quote



Ask a thought-provoking question

Topic: Plastic waste



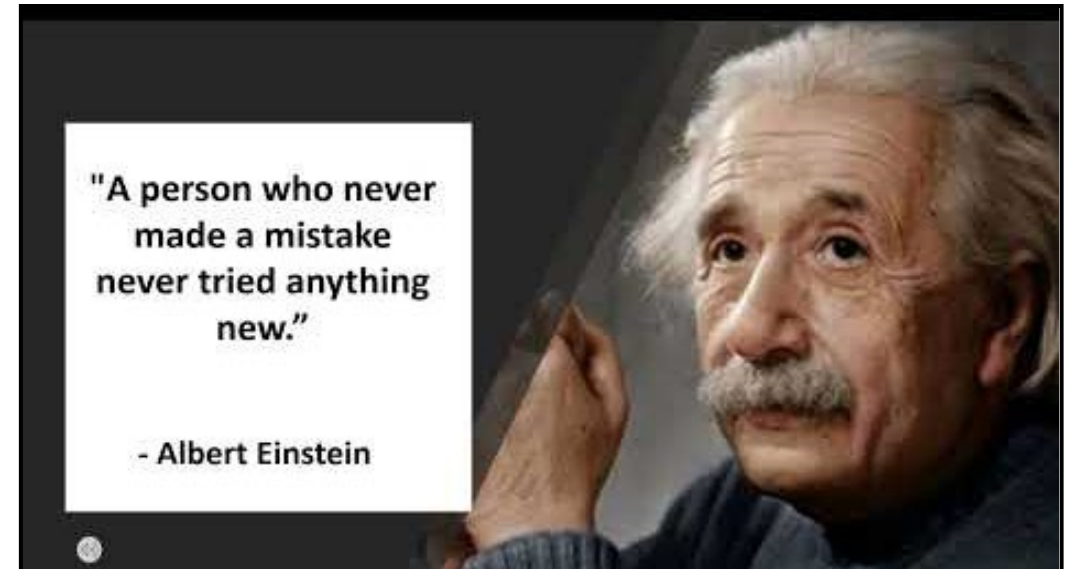
Script: [Thought provoking question.docx](#)

Link: https://youtu.be/_pnuHHUHjjs

Speaker: Shandon Siow, Diploma in AEG

Start with a quotation

Topic:
What failure taught me



Script: [Quotation .docx](#)

Link: <https://youtu.be/d1YhJ2v6g18>



Time to think: Selecting an attention getter

What attention getter would be appropriate for your speech?

Which of these factors would you need to consider when selecting one?

- Message? (Context/background)
- Audience? (Age, interest)
- Purpose?



Conclusion

Reiterate the Main Message

Include an Action Ending

Conclusion: Why reiterate the main message?

The DNA of my community

Main message in the Introduction:

"To me, it's my friends and family who are the most patient, accepting, and loving people I know – my P.A.L.s, if you will – Patient, Accepting, and Loving, P.A.L.s"

Main message in the Conclusion:

"My friends and family are my P.A.L.s – Patient, Accepting, and Loving, and that is the DNA of my community. It has nothing to do with things like my race. I should know because I have two of them. "



Action Ending

What does the action ending challenge the audience to do?

**"Maybe if we could all love others
our differences wouldn't
matter anymore."**

Action Endings

What is the purpose of an action ending?

To challenge the audience to think differently

- A quotation
- A poignant, moving or challenging statement

To challenge the listener to do something

- Spend more time with family members
- Visit a historical place
- Try a new sport or hobby
- Join a group that does good
- Etc.





Example 1: A quote and an action step

**“Do not be embarrassed by your failures;
learn from them and start again.”**

- Richard Branson, billionaire and founder of
The Virgin Group.

**What does this action ending challenge the
audience to do?**



Example 2: A question and an answer with an action step

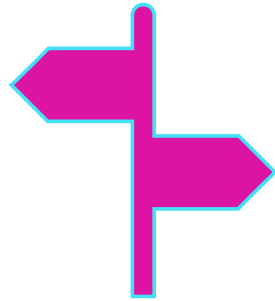


Why should plastic we use for a few minutes pollute our earth for 500 years?

Let's trade convenience for a healthier Earth.

What does this action ending challenge the audience to do?

Function of signposts in a speech



Putting the
speech
together
cohesively

Spoken & Written Language

Key Differences

Seminar (Speech)

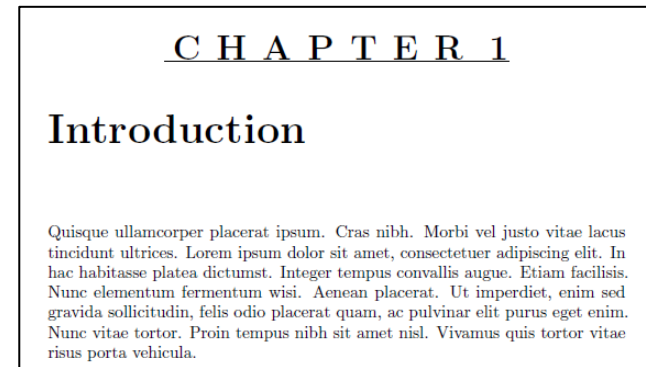
- **Signposts** guide listeners.
- Tell listeners that the speech is moving from one section or from one point to another.



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Article (Written)

- **Headings and subheadings** guide readers.
- Highlight the different sections of the article.



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Examples of signposts

Tells the listener
what to expect.

I will
discuss/highlight/
show/argue that

Signals the start of each new point

Firstly...

I will
begin by...

The first
reason...

Secondly..

Next...

Moving on.
I will...

Now, I will...

The third
reason...

What's the
final reason
for...? Wel...

Signals the conclusion

To conclude.

..

In
conclusion...



Key Learning Points

- Differences between an article and a script for a speech
- Elements of the language of a speech
- Rhetorical devices:
 - Rule of three
 - Use of contrast
 - Rhetorical questions
- Three-part structure of the seminar speech:
 - Attention getters
 - Action endings
- Function of signposts in structuring the speech

Week 11 E-Learning

1. Complete the E-Learning lesson.
2. Retrieve the template for your script from LMS.
3. Start drafting the Introduction.
 - Attention Getter
 - Main Message
4. Start drafting the Body.
 - Refer to the three points in your article.
5. Start drafting the Conclusion.
6. Complete all sections by Week 13.
7. Vacation Mission: Attend a webinar and answer the questions in LMS. Deadline: 5 Jul 2026.

